

Part A: *Pax*, Chapter 7 — Reading Comprehension

Circle the letter of the best answer for multiple-choice items. Answer the rest in complete sentences.

1. Who is curled against Pax when he wakes?
 - A. Bristle
 - B. Runt
 - C. Gray
 - D. Peter
2. Why does Pax send Runt away even though he enjoys the young fox's company?
3. What does Pax leave with Runt before returning to the road?
 - A. A wood rat
 - B. A strip of cloth
 - C. The plastic soldier
 - D. A feather
4. Describe the location of the fox dens. What features make the hillside a safe place?
5. Why does Pax refuse to leave the fallen oak even when he becomes dangerously thirsty?
6. What does Gray tell Pax about the road and the humans approaching from the west?
7. Gray calls some humans "false-acting." Explain what he means and identify the false-acting person Pax remembers.
8. Which statement best describes Gray's explanation of war?
 - A. A contest humans use to choose leaders
 - B. A human sickness that spreads chaos and destroys innocent life
 - C. A seasonal migration away from cold weather
 - D. A disagreement that affects soldiers but no one else

9. What evidence does Pax give that Peter is not careless toward animals?
10. What decision does Pax make at the end of the chapter, and why does Gray offer to travel with him?

Part B: *Pax*, Chapter 8 — Reading Comprehension

Circle the letter of the best answer for multiple-choice items. Answer the rest in complete sentences.

11. What wakes Peter, and what shocks him when he opens his eyes?
12. Which detail first shows that Vola is an amputee?
- A. She walks with two metal crutches
 - B. She rolls up her overalls and reveals a wooden lower leg
 - C. She tells Peter she lost her foot in an accident
 - D. Peter sees a prosthetic leg hanging on the wall
13. How does Vola expose Peter's claim that he was returning from batting practice?
14. What injury does Vola diagnose, and why does she call Peter lucky?
15. What was Vola's former occupation?
- A. Veterinarian
 - B. Carpenter
 - C. Military medic
 - D. Police officer
16. Explain what Peter means when he says he is not running away *from* home but running away *to* home.

17. What truth does Vola insist Peter acknowledge about his father's participation in the war?
18. Why does Peter take Vola's knife, and what does he learn after returning it?
19. Name two things Vola does to help Peter despite her harsh manner.
20. What conflict remains unresolved when Vola orders Peter to leave?

Part C: *Pax*, Chapter 9 — Reading Comprehension

Answer each question in complete sentences.

21. What does Gray smell as he approaches the meadow, and why is the outsider challenging him?
22. How does Gray drive the challenger away? What does this reveal about Gray's position among the foxes?
23. What warning does Gray's mate receive from the west wind?
24. Why does Pax agree to rest in the meadow even though he wants to begin searching for Peter immediately?

25. Compare Runt's and Bristle's reactions when Pax returns.
26. Why does Pax begin backing away during Bristle and Runt's disagreement?
27. What claim by Pax alarms Runt and angers Bristle?
28. What repeated image signals the painful story Bristle is about to tell?
29. How does the plastic soldier function as a symbol in this chapter?
30. The chapter ends just as Bristle begins her story. Explain how this ending creates suspense.

Part D: Parts of Speech

Identify the part of speech of the **bolded** word: *noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, or conjunction*.

1. The fox waited **silently** beside the road. _____
2. Gray led Pax **toward** the stream. _____
3. The **storm** had washed the hillside clean. _____
4. Vola built a pair of **wooden** crutches. _____
5. Peter was frightened, **but** he told the truth. _____
6. **She** examined the swollen foot carefully. _____
7. Runt **bounded** across the meadow. _____
8. The old fox moved **cautiously** down the bank. _____
9. The stream passed **beneath** the road. _____
10. Pax could wait, **or** he could search for Peter. _____
11. A **distant** fire scented the western wind. _____
12. **They** watched the stranger flee. _____
13. Vola sharpened the **knife** at her workbench. _____
14. The crows **carried** news from the west. _____
15. Bristle stared **fiercely** at the human-stinker. _____
16. Peter leaned **against** the workbench. _____
17. Gray would travel south, **because** his family needed safety. _____
18. The **pregnant** vixen waited on the ledge. _____
19. **Everyone** deserves help sometimes. _____
20. War destroys homes **and** habitats. _____

Part E: Subject and Predicate

For each sentence write (a) the complete subject, (b) the complete predicate, (c) the simple subject, and (d) the simple predicate.

1. The exhausted fox waited beside the silent road.
2. Gray and Pax followed the stream through the woods.
3. Beneath the road rushed a cold, clear stream.
4. The distant scent of fire worried the foxes.
5. Vola's sharp questions exposed Peter's story.
6. The former medic examined the swollen foot.
7. On the barn wall hung several carving tools.
8. Peter accepted the crutches and approached the door.
9. Bristle and her brother argued over the toy soldier.
10. A rough-furred stranger challenged Gray.

11. From the western forest came the smell of smoke.

12. The pregnant vixen shared an urgent warning.

13. Runt retrieved the toy and displayed it proudly.

14. The memory of steel traps terrified Bristle.

15. Pax's loyalty to Peter guided every decision.

Part F: Subject–Verb Agreement

Circle the correct verb.

1. The scent of the soldiers (warn / warns) the foxes.
2. Each of the animals (need / needs) clean water.
3. Gray and Pax (travels / travel) toward the meadow.
4. Neither the storm nor the soldiers (stop / stops) Pax.
5. There (is / are) three entrances to the den.
6. The news from the crows (is / are) alarming.
7. A pair of wooden crutches (help / helps) Peter move.
8. Both of the young foxes (enjoy / enjoys) the toy.
9. Either Bristle or Runt (carry / carries) the soldier.
10. The tools on Vola's wall (look / looks) dangerous.
11. Everyone in the meadow (sense / senses) the danger.
12. Twenty miles (seem / seems) impossible with a broken foot.
13. Here (come / comes) the older foxes.
14. Some of the water (flow / flows) beneath the road.
15. Peter's fear and exhaustion (make / makes) clear thinking difficult.

Each sentence below has one agreement error. Rewrite it correctly.

16. The pack of supplies were scattered across the floor.
17. Neither Peter nor Vola trust the other completely.
18. There is several tools above the workbench.
19. Every one of the foxes face danger from the war.
20. The stories carried by the crows is frightening.